



PROPOSAL · THE LOSSLESS GROUP × LINK FREEDOM GROUP · SEPTEMBER 2026

Partnerships as Value Added Resellers

Put the namespace where the name is chosen — inside the tools that create the thing that needs a name.

PREPARED FOR
Link Freedom Group

VERSION
v1

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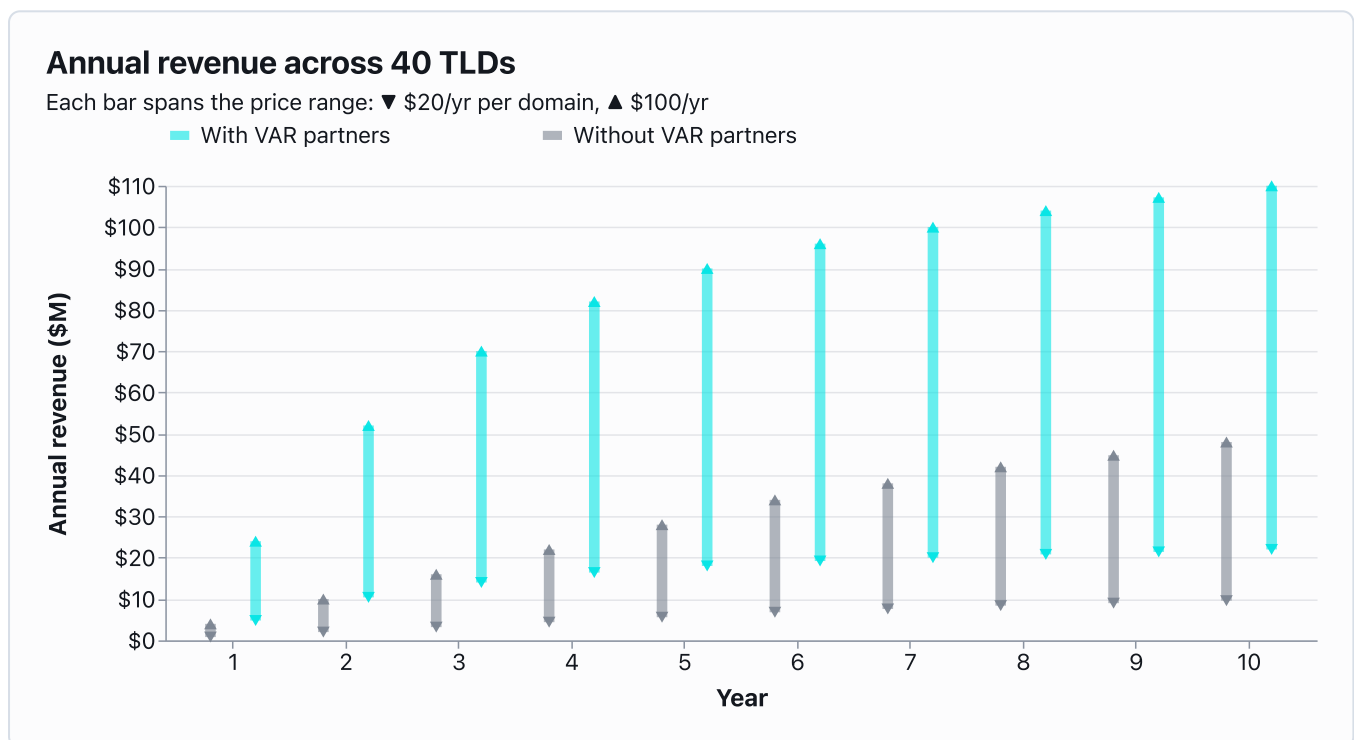
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What channels are worth over the life of the TLDs

A registry holds the right to administer a TLD for ten years. That is the window this decision plays out over, and the gap between the two bands below is the entire argument for building a channel at all.

Two views of the same model. The first shows what the TLDs earn **each year**; the second is the **running total**, which is the number that matters when the right to administer a TLD lasts ten years.

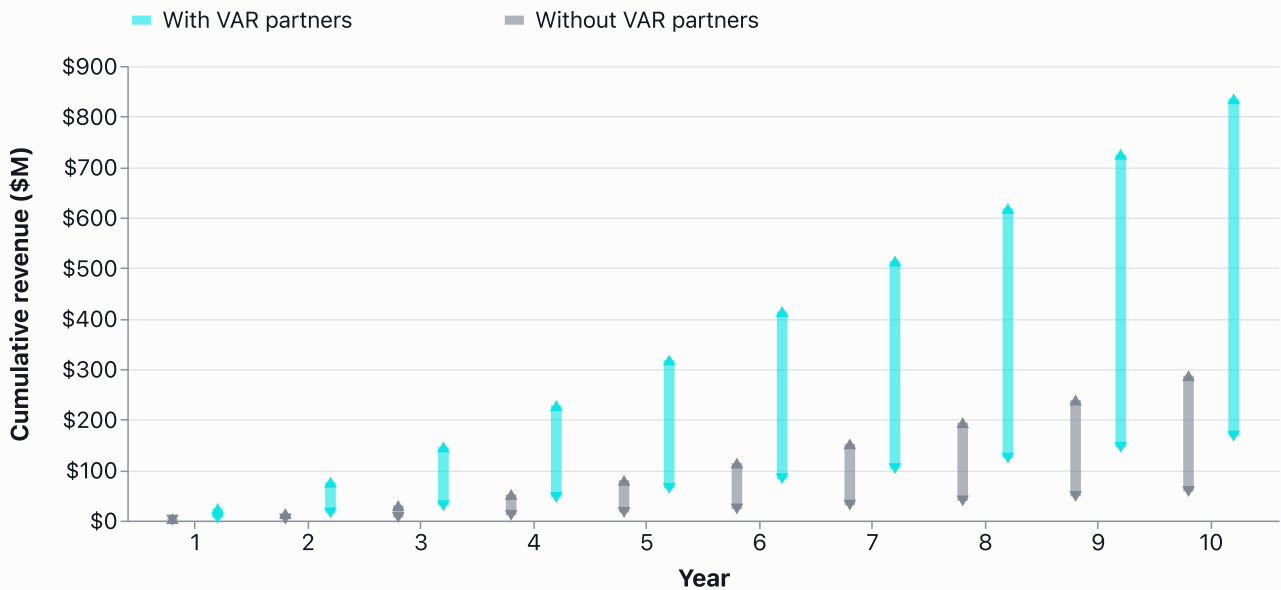
Every bar spans the price range rather than asserting a price: the ▼ marker is \$20 a year per domain, the ▲ marker is \$100. Hover any bar for its exact figures; click a legend switch to isolate one scenario, and click it again to bring both back.



The shape is the argument. Channel partners put the namespace in front of people at the moment they are naming something, from launch — so year one opens at roughly **six times** the volume the conventional path reaches, and the two lines never converge again.

Cumulative revenue, ten-year TLD term

Running total. Year 10 equals the figures in the table below.



	CUMULATIVE, 10 YEARS
Without VAR partners	\$57M – \$287M
With VAR partners	\$167M – \$835M
Difference	\$110M – \$548M

What the model assumes

- **Without VAR partners** follows a `.app`-shaped curve: a steady registrar-led ramp that plateaus. `.app` is the fair comparison — Google's own developer TLD, credibly marketed, sold the conventional way, and 750,000 names after six years.
- **With VAR partners** follows a `.xyz`-shaped front: a hard pop in years one and two from being present wherever people build, which then smooths but never returns to the lower line. `.xyz` opened with 30,000 registrations on day one and passed 750,000 inside six months.

Both scenarios use the same 40 TLDs and the same two prices. **The only variable is distribution.**

These stay conservative. The upper scenario has the whole 40-TLD portfolio at about 1.1 million names by year ten — `.xyz` alone passed 6 million. Year one lands at 240,000 names across all forty, which `.xyz` beat by itself in under six months. No TLD here is modelled as a breakout.

Customers think of naming inside their workflows

But then they *must leave* — to a name marketplace, to register it.

Today a domain is something you leave your work to go buy, and then wire up yourself across two dashboards that disagree about what the records are called. When the registrar and the deploy target are the same platform, none of that exists — there is nothing to point at anything.

STATUS QUO

Go shop for a domain — then wire up the DNS yourself

Stop building. Open a marketplace, search, compare extensions, check out. Then the actual work starts: find the DNS panel, add the records, wait, come back, verify, and hope the certificate issues.

- Leave the thing you were making in order to go buy something
- A second vendor, a second checkout, a second account to remember
- Hand-configure A, AAAA, CNAME and TXT records across two dashboards, in a vocabulary most people get wrong at least once
- Or surrender the nameservers entirely, and now DNS lives somewhere else than the domain
- Wait for propagation, return, click verify, debug why the TLS certificate did not issue
- Renewal arrives a year later as a line item the buyer forgot about and resents

Comparison-shopping mindset · two vendors · DNS debugging · decision deferred

VAR POSSIBILITY

Embed domain selection inside the creative and developer tools

Resell the registration without the user ever leaving the tool — and because the platform is already the deploy target, there are no records to wire. It owns both ends of the thing the user would otherwise be hand-connecting.

- Never leave the thing you were making
- Availability is the whole experience, and a fresh namespace has nearly all of it
- One click, inside a session already authenticated and already billing
- Zero DNS configuration — the platform writes its own records, because it is both registrar and host
- TLS provisioned automatically; no propagation wait, no verify step, no failure mode to debug
- Renewal rides a subscription the user has already decided to keep

Impulse mindset · one click · zero records · decided in the moment

The DNS step is the underrated half of this. Buying a domain is a few minutes of annoyance; **connecting** one is the step where people actually stall — and it is the step every one of these platforms already pays for. "I connected my domain and the site doesn't load" is a standing support

category at Vercel, Netlify, Webflow and Squarespace alike, and it is generated almost entirely by the hand-off to a registrar the platform does not control. A platform that sells the domain writes the records itself, provisions the certificate itself, and deletes its own support burden in the process.

The other half of the wedge is availability. A person naming a project in 2026 hits the same wall every time: everything good in `.com` went twenty years ago, and the workarounds — hyphens, misspellings, five-word compounds — are a visible tax on a thing they just made. An agentic app builder makes this worse at machine scale: it will happily generate forty projects an afternoon, every one of which needs a name that resolves.

A brand-new namespace is the only thing that answers that, because on day one it is **almost entirely unclaimed**. `.api`, `.stack`, `.ship`, `.auth` and `.agentic` are not better TLDs than `.com` in the abstract. They are dramatically better TLDs *at the moment of naming*, because the name you want is still there.

That is the value the platform adds, and it is why this is a VAR relationship rather than an affiliate link: the platform is not forwarding traffic to a registrar, it is **collapsing four steps into one inside its own product** — and converting a deliberate purchase into an impulse one.

What I am proposing to do

Engage me — Michael Staton, using the brand [The Lossless Group](#) — to build LFG's Value Added Reseller channel among developer and creation platforms, and to close the first cohort of it.

The Lossless Group is an umbrella brand for a loose group of collaborators, run by me. It serves as the DBA and as a destination resource for consulting clients. In practice that means me, plus collaborators brought in as the work calls for them — talent on demand, and friends between things. **That cost sits with me, not with you.** There is no bench to justify, no staffing plan to approve, and no change order when a phase needs a skill I do not personally have.

Concretely, the engagement produces four things:

1. **A channel thesis and one-pager per target archetype** — the version of the LFG pitch that a Vercel or a Bubble partnerships lead can take to their own product council without translation.
2. **A tiered, named target list** with routes in, warm where warm exists, maintained against the toolkit census rather than assembled once.
3. **A reference VAR deal structure** — commercial terms, margin treatment, and the technical integration shape — so each conversation starts from a proposal rather than a discovery call.
4. **A viable plan for mass-scale industry coverage, to meaningfully pop early sales** — a sequenced, costed route to the channel being live across the category rather than live in three places. Coverage is the objective the plan is built against; the plan itself is what the first month delivers.

Go big or go home: massive coverage at launch

A few pilots will not do it. What year one needs is massive acceptance — enough platforms live at once that demand does not have to be created, it gets captured wherever someone happens to be building. At that density the channel starts working on the partners too: once a handful of the obvious names have shipped it, the rest are answering why they have not, and **FOMO does the selling**. Anything less and year one is spent demonstrating rather than selling.

What that means you are buying

I bring navigation wisdom, a massive network and deeply trusting relationships, and state-of-the-art awareness across a broad range of potential channel partners. Those are the parts of this that decide whether it works: the thesis, the target list, the terms, and the conversations that

turn those into signatures. **I am an elite commando at creating opportunities, and I bring that from day one.**

 The shape is proposed, the numbers are open

One month of precursor planning, then twelve months with decision gates at months 2, 6 and 10. Paid three ways: a retainer, a bonus per partnership signed, and a channel share that descends from 5% in year one to 1% in year five — so I am paid most when revenue arrives earliest. The full structure is in "Proposed engagement". Every figure is deliberately blank pending a budget range from you.

Categories of potential Value Added Resellers

The field is wider than the AI-native builders everyone lists. All of it sits under one VAR agreement — what changes between categories is the go-to-market motion: who the buyer is, how the domain reaches the end user, and how long the cycle runs.

MOTION 1

Product-embedded

The domain is a step inside the partner's own creation flow. The end user never leaves, and the partner books the registration as part of its own product.

- Buyer: partnerships or product
- Reaches the user: inside the build, at the naming moment
- Cycle: one to two quarters, roadmap-bound

MOTION 2

Community & reference

Open-source projects and developer tools with audiences rather than checkout flows. Entry is usually a sponsorship; the same agreement still governs anything they resell to their own users later.

- Buyer: a maintainer, a foundation, or a DevRel lead
- Reaches the user: by visible example and documentation
- Cycle: weeks — the fastest motion in the field

MOTION 3

Infrastructure attach

The domain attaches to a provisioned machine or an inference endpoint rather than a generated app. Largest accounts, most procurement, longest runway.

- Buyer: ops, infra, or platform engineering
- Reaches the user: at provisioning, or in the control panel
- Cycle: two to four quarters, procurement-bound

MOTION 4

Use-case anchor

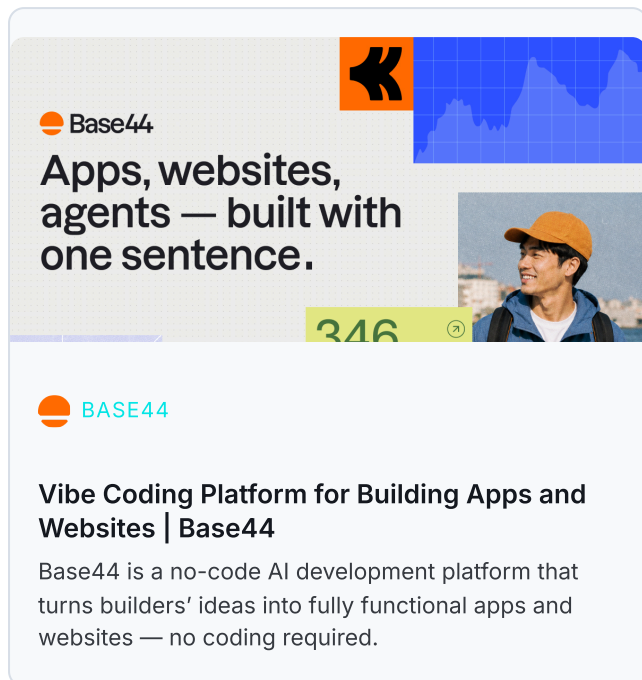
One TLD matched to the category leader that defines it. Airbnb on .bnb, a forms platform on .form. The anchor does not buy volume — it tells everyone else what the TLD is for.

- Buyer: brand, marketing, or the founder directly
- Reaches the user: by making the TLD legible at a glance
- Cycle: slow, but it only has to happen once per TLD

CATEGORY	WHAT GETS NAMED	REPRESENTATIVE NAMES	GTM MOTION
Agentic app builders	The app the agent just generated	Replit, Lovable, Bolt, v0, Base44 , Mocha , Woz , PartyKit	Product-embedded
WYSIWYG app builders	The internal tool or database app	Bubble , Glide , Knack , Ragic , SeaTable , AppSheet , UI Bakery , FlutterFlow , OutSystems	Product-embedded
Agentic site builders	The site generated from a prompt	Durable , Coframe , Relume , Rocket	Product-embedded
WYSIWYG site builders	The designed site at publish	Webflow, Framer, Squarespace, Wix, Webstudio , TeleportHQ , GrapesJS	Product-embedded
Opsless / serverless deploy	The deployment target	Vercel, Netlify	Product-embedded
One-click container deploys	The running service, at first deploy	Railway , Render , Fly.io , Sealos , Coolify , Dokploy , Porter , Koyeb	Product-embedded
Documentation engines	The docs site at publish	Starlight , Mintlify , ReadMe , Docmost , Antora , Paligo , Zeroheight , Kapa	Product-embedded
GTM automation, CRO & AEO suites	Every campaign microsite, landing page and test variant	Mutiny , Conductor , Fast.io	Product-embedded — highest volume per customer
Publishing & newsletter platforms	The publication, at launch	Ghost , Letterhead , Substack , beehiiv , Buttondown , Kit , WordPress	Product-embedded — already resells domains
Baremetal hosting	The provisioned box	Hetzner , Hostinger	Infrastructure attach
GPU / compute hosting	The inference endpoint	Lambda , Modal , Nebius , Vast.ai	Infrastructure attach
One-stop-shop hosting	Anything the customer runs	DigitalOcean , Linode , Vultr , OVHcloud , Scaleway , Contabo	Infrastructure attach

Most of these names are three to five years old and unfamiliar outside the category. **Every one is explained in one line in the [appendix](#).**

The names, as their own sites present them



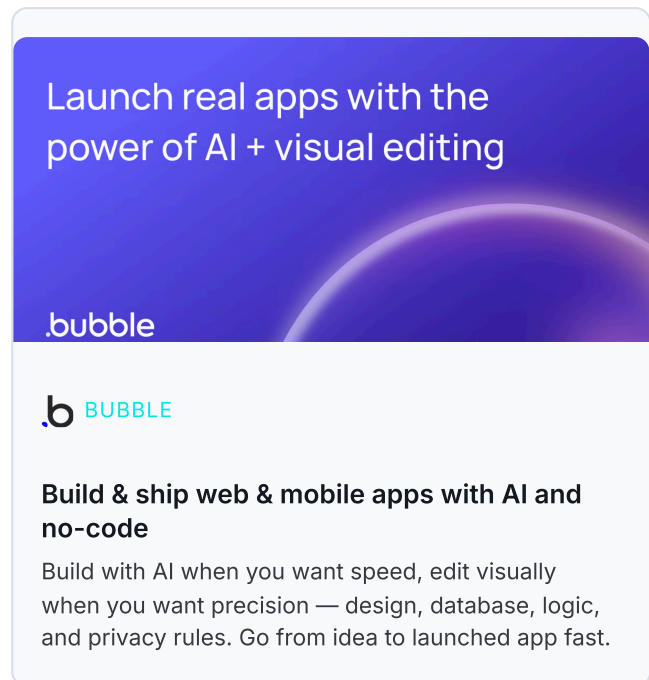
Base44

Apps, websites, agents — built with one sentence.

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Vibe Coding Platform for Building Apps and Websites | Base44

Base44 is a no-code AI development platform that turns builders' ideas into fully functional apps and websites — no coding required.



Launch real apps with the power of AI + visual editing

.bubble

b BUBBLE

Build & ship web & mobile apps with AI and no-code

Build with AI when you want speed, edit visually when you want precision — design, database, logic, and privacy rules. Go from idea to launched app fast.

One agreement, three motions, and a sequence

The commercial paper does not change across these fourteen categories. A single VAR agreement — wholesale floor, margin split, support boundary, registrar of record — covers a documentation engine, a GPU host and an open-source project alike. **That is an asset, not a simplification:** the reference deal gets written once and then every conversation starts from a document instead of a discovery call.

What changes is the motion, and the motion determines the order.

Community and reference goes first, because it is the precondition. No platform will merchandise a namespace that nobody credible uses. A sponsorship costs a rounding error against a partnership cycle and produces the one thing the partnership conversation needs: a real, visible, respected project living on the TLD. `ffmpeg` on an LFG extension is worth more in a Vercel meeting than any deck. It is also the fastest motion — weeks, not quarters, because a maintainer decides alone.

Product-embedded is the revenue. The first seven rows sell registrations inside a flow that already exists, which is where the volume argument from the following sections lives.

Infrastructure attach is the endgame. The largest accounts, the most procurement, and the partners most likely to want proof before they touch it. Worth opening late and deliberately.

Two categories that deserve their own note

Documentation engines are the GEO play in disguise. Docs and READMEs are among the most-cited third-party sources in AI answers about technical subjects. A TLD that appears in the canonical documentation of widely-used tools enters training corpora and retrieval indexes as a matter of course. That is the cross-referencing argument from the portfolio section — except run for LFG's own namespace rather than a customer's brand. Starlight, Mintlify and ReadMe each publish thousands of docs sites, every one of which resolves at a domain.

One-click container deploys are the closest thing to a free win. A container platform assigns every service a throwaway subdomain at first deploy — `myapp-production-4f2a.up.railway.app` and its equivalents — and the user's first instinct on anything they intend to keep is to attach a real domain. The naming moment is already instrumented, the DNS is already controlled by the platform, and the upgrade from throwaway to owned is a single obvious step. [Railway](#) is the notable omission from the toolkit's current One-Click Deployments tag and belongs at the front of this row.

GTM automation suites carry the highest domains-per-customer number in the field. A campaign microsite per test, per segment, per geography is the portfolio effect operationalised — and unlike a brand's defensive registrations, these are bought continuously rather than once. It is the one category where the per-account domain count is measured in dozens a year rather than units. [Letterhead](#) sells "10× your newsletters", which is a domains multiplier stated as a product promise, and [Ghost](#) attaches a domain to every publication it hosts — while also being open source, so it can be reached through either motion.

Publishing platforms are the proof that this model already works. Substack and beehiiv both charge for connecting a custom domain, and Ghost has supported it since the beginning. That is a domain product, sold inside a creation flow, to a customer who has just made something they want to name — the exact motion this proposal describes, running profitably today at companies nobody thinks of as registrars. The difference LFG can make is inventory: every one of those platforms currently sends the customer to a third party to buy the name, and every one of them is selling into a `.com` market where the good names are gone.

[Conductor](#) deserves singling out. It sells itself as the enterprise platform for **answer engine optimisation** — "where enterprises go to win in AI search." Its entire product is the argument the portfolio section makes, sold to exactly the buyers who already fund it. A partner whose customers are paying to be cited more often by generative engines is the most natural possible distribution for a namespace whose pitch is more credible owned properties. That is a first conversation, not a late one.

The open-source axis

"Open-source sponsorship" is not one category sitting beside documentation engines and GPU hosts — it is a second axis that cuts across every kind of software there is. It gets its own table because the unit is a **kind of project**, not a kind of company, and because each kind maps to a different part of

LFG's namespace.

KIND OF PROJECT	REPRESENTATIVE PROJECTS	TLDs THAT FIT
Media & image processing	ffmpeg , ImageMagick , GStreamer	<code>.raw</code> <code>.cast</code> <code>.print</code>
Databases & the data layer	libSQL , DuckDB , Prisma , Drizzle	<code>.file</code> <code>.model</code> <code>.state</code>
Terminal & CLI tools	ripgrep , fzf , eza , Zellij , Yazi , Atuin	<code>.find</code> <code>.list</code> <code>.pod</code> <code>.index</code>
Editors & source control	Helix , Neovim , Jujutsu	<code>.text</code> <code>.source</code> <code>.mode</code>
Containers & infrastructure	Podman , Caddy , Prometheus , OpenTofu	<code>.pod</code> <code>.port</code> <code>.state</code>
AI & local inference	Ollama , llama.cpp , MLX , vLLM	<code>.llm</code> <code>.machine</code> <code>.train</code>
Docs, markup & conversion	Pandoc , Mermaid , Starlight	<code>.print</code> <code>.text</code> <code>.view</code>
Security & cryptography	GnuPG , OpenSSL , Let's Encrypt	<code>.key</code> <code>.auth</code>
Scientific & numeric	NumPy , Jupyter , Tesseract	<code>.math</code> <code>.sci</code> <code>.research</code> <code>.scan</code>
Developer context tooling	Agent Skills , Chroma , OpenSpec	<code>.file</code> <code>.index</code> <code>.agentic</code>

Ten kinds of project, nine TLDs of LFG's namespace covered, and a target list that can be worked in parallel because no two conversations depend on each other. The next table narrows this to the pairings sharp enough to be worth leading with.

TLDs that already have an obvious partner

The community motion gets vague fast — "sponsor some open source" is not a plan. It stops being vague the moment you pair a specific TLD with the specific project everyone already has installed. The pairings below came from auditing the 185 Homebrew formulae on one working developer's machine, then matching each tool against LFG's published namespace. **Every TLD in this table is one LFG has.**

TLD	THE OBVIOUS PARTNER	WHY IT FITS	LFG'S OWN TAGLINE
<code>.tldr</code>	tldr	The name is already the TLD	"Shortcuts for busy lives"
<code>.find</code>	ripgrep , fzf	Search is the entire product	"Find what you didn't know you needed"
<code>.scan</code>	Tesseract	OCR, literally scanning	"Instant look, instant record"
<code>.tag</code>	ExifTool	Reads and writes metadata tags	"Tag it, track it, know it"
<code>.list</code>	eza	A modern <code>ls</code>	"Where everything comes together"
<code>.text</code>	Helix , Neovim	Terminal text editors	"Words on the wire"
<code>.source</code>	Jujutsu	Source control, and small enough to say yes	"The root of it all"
<code>.file</code>	Agent Skills , libSQL	A skill <i>is</i> one file you drop in; a libSQL database is one file too	"All your info, one place"
<code>.model</code>	Prisma , Drizzle	An ORM's job is defining the data model — <code>model User {}</code> is literally Prisma's syntax	"The reference point"
<code>.raw</code>	ffmpeg , ImageMagick	Media in its unprocessed form	"Not done yet"
<code>.pod</code>	Podman , Zellij	Containers and multiplexed panes	"Pack it, keep it, carry on"
<code>.llm</code>	Ollama	Local inference	"Words that work for you"
<code>.key</code>	GnuPG , OpenSSL	Keys and signing	"Open doors, new possibilities"
<code>.index</code>	Atuin	Searchable shell history	"Everything in its right place"
<code>.print</code>	Pandoc	Document conversion	"Create, share, repeat"

These are not hobby projects — several are among the most widely deployed software on earth, and the [appendix](#) says what each one is and how widely it is used.

Several of these are close enough to be memorable on sight. `tldr` on `.tldr` is an exact match, and `.model` is close behind — Prisma's schema files are written in a syntax whose keyword *is* `model`. [Tesseract](#) on `.scan`, [ExifTool](#) on `.tag` and [SQLite](#) on `.file` each describe the tool better than the tool's current domain does.

`.file` and [agent skills](#) is the one unclaimed naming space on this list. An [Agent Skill](#) is, by design, a single markdown file you drop into a directory — "it's just a file" is the entire pitch of the format. The ecosystem is roughly a year old, registries are still forming, and **no naming convention has settled yet**. Every other pairing in this table means persuading a project to move from a domain it already has. This one means being there before the convention exists, which is a different and much cheaper kind of win.

It is also the category where I have standing rather than a cold introduction: The Lossless Group maintains its own public [agent-skills repository](#), and the skills in it are used daily across a twenty-seven repository tree. I can open these conversations as a participant.

Two things this table is actually for. It converts the community motion from a budget line into **a list of fourteen named conversations**, each with a maintainer who can say yes alone. And it is the cheapest credibility in the plan: a developer who types `brew install all day meeting .find` at ripgrep learns what the namespace is for without reading a word of marketing.

Use-case anchors and preferred partners

`.link` is already delegated and already administered by LFG, which makes it the one TLD where all of this can happen immediately — no waiting on evaluation, contention or delegation. Starlink on `.link` is an anchor conversation available today, and the same is true of every link-in-bio and short-link platform in the market.

Beyond it, some TLDs have an obvious owner. `.form` belongs in front of [Typeform](#), [Makeform](#), [Jotform](#) and [Tally](#). `.bnb` belongs in front of [Airbnb](#) — LFG's own tagline for the TLD, "wake up somewhere new, every time," is already written to that use. An anchor of that size does something no marketing spend does: it tells every subsequent buyer what the TLD is for.

TLD	CATEGORY IT DEFINES	CANDIDATE ANCHORS
<code>.link</code> (live today)	Connectivity and networks	Starlink , link-in-bio and short-link platforms
<code>.form</code>	Forms and surveys	Typeform, Jotform, Tally, Makeform
<code>.bnb</code>	Short-term rental	Airbnb, Vrbo, Booking
<code>.stay</code>	Hospitality	Marriott, Hilton, Hyatt
<code>.ride</code>	Mobility	Uber, Lyft
<code>.cast</code>	Podcasting	Spotify, Substack, Transistor
<code>.hire</code>	Recruiting	LinkedIn, Greenhouse, Ashby
<code>.jet</code>	Private aviation	NetJets, Wheels Up
<code>.mall</code> <code>.sell</code>	Commerce	Shopify, Etsy

One more reason anchors matter now: the 2026 round closed with **more than 1,600 applications**. ^[1] Standing out in a field that size is not a marketing budget problem. It is a "who famously uses it" problem.

VAR Partners can boost early adoption

LFG has published 316 proposed TLDs, primary and replacement, with roughly 40 emphasized as the near-term focus. Fifty of them carry a clear commercial buyer. The platform channel is the one distribution path that can be wired while the application process is still running.

316

Proposed TLDs in the published namespace

Primary and replacement, per LFG's namespace explorer

~40

The near-term focus LFG emphasizes

At ~\$1M all-in each, roughly \$40M committed pre-revenue

50

TLDs on the commercial focus list

First-pass read, all verified in the published 316

On the day a TLD is released, nobody notices. Sales accumulate slowly from there, and the new extension spends that whole time competing against every other alternative on the shelf. Name options surface only for the people who have already chosen to go shopping for a name. [\[2\]](#)

That is the shape of the traditional path: accreditation, registrar onboarding, marketplace listing, promotional slots. It is **demand-pull**, it works, and LFG should run it. Its ceiling is the number of people who show up shopping.

The platform channel is the opposite shape. It is **demand-capture**: it meets a person at the moment they have just made something and need to name it. That moment already exists inside Vercel, Replit, Webflow, Figma, Lovable and every agentic app builder shipped in the last eighteen months. Today it ends with a hand-off to a third-party registrar. It could end with a registration.

There is also a live TLD to do it with. **LFG already administers `.link`**, so the channel does not have to wait for a single 2026-round application to clear evaluation. A platform integration can ship against a delegated, resolving TLD this quarter, bill real registrations, and produce real attach data — which is the evidence every later conversation needs and which no competitor in this round can currently show.

The reason to start now, rather than at delegation, is that platform integration is a **product** decision on their side, not a marketing one. It moves on their roadmap cycle — a quarter or two of lead time, minimum. Signed before delegation, the channel is live on day one. Started after, the first year is spent waiting for someone else's sprint planning.

What the numbers say a new extension is actually worth

New gTLDs are the fastest-growing part of the domain market, and the single best performer of the last decade won on relevance, not distribution. Both facts matter here.

52.9M

Domains on new gTLDs, end of June 2026

Growing 31.3% YoY against 3.7% for .com and .net

1M+

.ai registrations, passed January 2026

\$93M of 2025 revenue — 47% of Anguilla's national budget

750K

Total .app domains after six years

Google's own developer TLD, sold the conventional way

The domain market is 401.6 million names, and .com and .net are 176.1 million of it — under half, and growing at 3.7% a year. New gTLDs are 52.9 million and growing at 31.3%, roughly eight times faster. [\[3\]](#) The category is not the problem. The question is only how fast a *particular* new extension gets from delegation to volume, and there the record is unambiguous.

EXTENSION	OPENED	EARLY TRACTION	WHERE IT GOT TO	HOW IT WAS SOLD
.xyz	Jun 2014	30,000 on day one; 750,000 inside ~6 months	6M+ by mid-2025	Registrar promotion, heavy discounting, free giveaways [4]
.app	May 2018	"Hundreds of thousands" in the first 12 months	750,803 by Jul 2024	Google's brand, through registrars [5]
.dev	Mar 2019	—	600,000+ over five years	Google's brand, through registrars [6]
.ai	ccTLD	—	1M+ by Jan 2026, ~2,008/day	No channel innovation at all [7]

The two lessons, and they point in opposite directions

.app and .dev are the warning. Google — the most credible developer brand that exists, with Chrome, Android, Search and a captive developer audience — launched two developer-targeted TLDs and sold them the conventional way. Six years later **.app** is at 750,000 and **.dev** at 600,000. That is roughly the ceiling of demand-pull distribution for a developer extension, and Google could not raise it with brand alone. Worth noting: Google then sold its entire registrar business — about 10 million domains — to **Squarespace, a website builder**, for \$180M. [\[8\]](#) The buyer was a place where people *build things*.

.ai is the proof. It reached a million registrations and \$93M of annual revenue with no channel program, no platform deals, and a government of 15,000 people running it. It won purely because the TLD matched what everyone was building at the moment they needed a name.

LFG's bet needs both halves. The namespace supplies the relevance that `.ai` had. The VAR channel supplies the distribution that `.app` never got.

Why this is necessity, not upside

At roughly **\$1M all-in per application across the ~40 TLDs LFG emphasizes as the near-term focus, about \$40M is committed before a single domain sells**. At a \$20 average annual registration, \$40M of yearly gross revenue requires on the order of **two million domains under management**. `.app` took six years to reach three-quarters of one million, with Google behind it.

The conventional registrar channel, on its own, does not clear that bar on any timeline that makes the investment work. That is the real argument for this engagement. The platform channel is not a clever additional idea — it is the only distribution model on the table with the shape to produce order-of-magnitude volume in years one and two, which is precisely when it is needed.

TK — the revenue model underneath this

The \$20 figure is my placeholder, not LFG's. Wholesale price per TLD, premium/reserved tiers, expected renewal rate, and the registrar margin split all move this arithmetic substantially. Give me the intended pricing model and I will rebuild this with your numbers — it is the single calculation a partner's finance team will redo themselves.

Sell a portfolio: the logic of SEO, GEO, and the gamification of cross-referenced content

Every number in the previous section assumed one domain per customer. That assumption is wrong, and it has been wrong since long before AI answers existed.

68%

of AI citations come from third-party sources

Only 32% come from the brand's own website

8,300

Average domain portfolio, Global 2000 top 50

At an average spend of \$373,000 a year

93%

of searches in Google's AI Mode end without a click

Against 34% in classic search with no AI Overview

The precedent

The SEO industry solved this problem twenty years ago, and solved it cynically. Link farms and private blog networks are portfolios of cheap properties whose only job is to point at a client. Each link is a vote; volume of votes moves the ranking. Google has spent two decades penalising the spam end of it, but the underlying insight survived every algorithm update: **a brand referenced from many places outranks a brand referenced from one.**

What changed

Search engines returned a list and the click was the prize. Generative engines return an answer, and the prize is being **inside** it. That shift is measurable and it is fast: **68.01%** of Google searches ended without a click in the first four months of 2026, up from 60.45% in 2024 — and in Google's AI Mode the figure is **93%**. [\[9\]](#) A ranking you cannot click is worth very little.

What counts instead is citation and mention frequency, and here the numbers are pointed. **68% of AI citations come from third-party sources; only 32% come from the brand's own website.** [\[10\]](#) Seer Interactive measured a **65% correlation** between how often a brand is mentioned across web content and how often it appears in AI-generated answers. [\[11\]](#) The Princeton and IIT Delhi team that formalised GEO at KDD 2024 found that content carrying statistics and quotations earned **30–40% higher visibility** in generated answers than the same content without them. [\[12\]](#)

Read those together and the strategy writes itself. If two thirds of what an engine says about you originates somewhere other than your own site, then the number of credible properties you control is a direct input to how you are described. This is the link-farm insight again, pointed at a different engine — except that this time the assets are real properties with real content, because generative engines weight source credibility rather than raw link count.

Brands already fund this

Defensive registration is not a new budget line; it is one of the largest in corporate domain management. The top 50 of the Global 2000 average roughly **8,300 domains** each, at an average annual spend near **\$373,000**. ^[13] A 2025 study of the Fortune 500 counted **19,523 defensive domains across 447 companies**. ^[14] The money is already being spent, every year, to stop someone else owning a variant of a name.

A new namespace does two things to that budget at once. It creates new variants worth defending, and it offers new variants worth *using* — which is the difference between a cost line and an investment.

My own portfolio, as the worked example

I own five `lossless.*` extensions for The Lossless Group. For a venture brand I am holding, `mandatory.*`, I own eleven. That was not completionism. Two motives, and both generalise:

1. **Cost of displacement.** Anyone who wants that brand now has to acquire eleven positions instead of one. The price of taking it from me went up by an order of magnitude, and I paid retail registration fees to do it.
2. **Surface count.** Each extension is a property that can carry real content and reference the others. Under the citation arithmetic above, that is eleven chances to be the third-party source rather than one.

I am a single founder with no domain budget to speak of. A funded company with a brand worth defending does this reflexively and at larger scale.

What this does to the arithmetic

The previous section needed roughly two million domains under management to justify the investment, assuming one domain per customer. Move that assumption to five and the same revenue needs 400,000 customers. Move it to eleven and it needs under 200,000. **The portfolio effect is the difference between needing a mass consumer market and needing a serious professional one** — and the professional one is exactly what sits inside the platforms in the reach table.

It also changes the product a platform sells. A single domain is a \$20 transaction bolted onto a signup flow. A namespace bundle — your brand across the five extensions that fit your category, registered in one action, renewing together — is a meaningfully larger product, and one no incumbent registrar can assemble because no incumbent controls a coherent namespace.

Where the line is

Private blog networks get penalised because the properties are fake: generated content, no audience, existing only to pass authority. The strategy that works under generative engines is the opposite, because these engines weight source credibility. Real documentation on

.api , a real changelog on .dev -style infrastructure TLDs, a real research index on .labs — separate credible properties that genuinely cross-reference. Worth stating plainly in any partner-facing material, because a sophisticated partner will raise the link-farm comparison before we do.

 TK — does LFG want to sell bundles

This section argues the unit of sale should be a portfolio rather than a domain. That is a registry pricing decision: multi-extension bundle pricing, whether a brand can reserve a TLD across several extensions at once, and whether renewals can be collapsed into one date. If the answer is yes, it becomes the most differentiated thing a platform partner could put in front of a customer, and I would lead the pitch with it.

Why a platform says yes to this

A partnerships lead has to defend this internally. These are the four defences, roughly in the order they work.

1 · It closes a hole they already have

Custom-domain attach is a known conversion and retention lever on every one of these platforms, and today every one of them ends that flow by sending the user to somebody else. They capture none of the revenue — and still absorb the support tickets when the records come back wrong, because the failure surfaces on their site, not the registrar's.

2 · It is differentiation they cannot buy elsewhere

Any platform can resell .com. A namespace under LFG's control can be positioned, merchandised, and priced as that platform's own — a curated set of extensions that fit its audience, with availability nobody else can offer.

3 · The unit economics are clean

Registration and renewal are recurring, high-margin, and already inside the platform's billing relationship. No new payment surface, no new support burden if the registry-of-record sits behind an API.

4 · Agents make naming a volume problem

An AI app builder generates names continuously and needs them to resolve. A namespace with near-total availability is infrastructure for that, not an upsell — and the platform that wires it first sets the default.

The fourth argument is the one I would lead with at Replit, Lovable, Bolt, v0 and the rest of the agentic-builder cohort, because for them naming is not a merchandising opportunity, it is a **bottleneck in the core loop**. Everywhere else, lead with the first.

What they will push back on

Three objections, every time: *who is the registrar of record and who eats support; what happens if the TLD is contested or never delegates; and what do we tell a user who wants a .com*. The reference deal structure in "What a VAR integration actually is" has to answer all three in writing before the first meeting, or the first meeting becomes the only meeting.

Fifty that might sell the most, per my assumptions

Every TLD below is in LFG's published namespace. They are grouped by who writes the cheque, because that determines which channel sells them and none of them sell the same way.

50

TLDs on the first-pass focus list
All 50 verified present in the published 316

7

That replace a subdomain a brand already runs
Portfolio additions — a different buyer, a different motion

7

With a named flagship partner
Covered in the preferred-partnership section

AI, research and the agentic layer

TLD	WHO BUYS IT	MOTION THAT REACHES THEM
.agi .intelligence .research .labs	Foundation research labs, science labs, university departments	Community & reference — these are institutions, reached by example
.agentic	AI companies and context-layer startups	Product-embedded, via the agentic builders
.brain	Context layers, RAG, the "org brain" for employees and networks	Product-embedded
.gen	AI companies, LLMs, generative creative — and long-horizon capital firms (next.gen)	Split: product-embedded and direct brand
.mate	Copilots and agent assistants	Product-embedded
.flow	Agentic workflow products	Product-embedded
.gpt	GPT-for-everything — OpenAI as the flagship partner	Preferred partnership

Developer tools and infrastructure

TLD	WHO BUYS IT	MOTION THAT REACHES THEM
.hack .sys	Dev tools, developer infrastructure	Community & reference, then product-embedded
.ship	Dev tools, and e-commerce	Product-embedded, via deploy platforms
.stack	Enterprise SaaS	Direct brand, long cycle
.file	Agent skills, packages, libraries	Community & reference — the unclaimed naming space
.add	Packages, libraries, registries	Community & reference
.project	Interim initiatives, work that is pre-brand	Product-embedded — the naming moment exactly

Portfolio additions, defensive squats: replaces subdomains

Every one of these replaces a subdomain a company is already running. The TLD does not create a new need — it **reverses an existing one**, and reads better in the reversal.

TLD	THE SUBDOMAIN IT REPLACES	BECOMES
.form	forms.insurance.com	insurance.form
.auth .pass	auth.company.com	company.auth , company.pass
.demo	demo.company.com	company.demo
.sign	sign.company.com	company.sign
.feed	feed.company.com	company.feed
.era	—	the wordplay buys: course.era , cloud.era

This is the strongest demand argument in the namespace, and it is the least speculative. **A company does not have to be persuaded it needs a login page or an intake form — it already has one, at a subdomain, today.** The offer is a cleaner address for a thing that exists, plus the certainty that a competitor or a squatter cannot take the brand's own name on that TLD.

Two consequences follow. The buyer is the brand and its registrar rather than a platform, so this revenue arrives through the portfolio motion and not the channel — **a separate line with a separate sales motion**. And the domains-per-customer number stops being an estimate: a mid-size company runs somewhere between five and fifteen subdomains of exactly this kind, so the multiplier in the portfolio section has a floor that can be counted rather than modelled.

.pass is the exception that earns its place twice. Alongside the auth use it has a real consumer destination — **memberships and ticket sales** — which makes it the only TLD in this group a company would buy to put in front of customers rather than to keep off the market. It should be pitched into both motions.

It also renews with near-certainty. A defensive registration is never cancelled while the brand exists, and one that is carrying live traffic at insurance.form is not cancelled at all.

Community, media and commerce

TLD	WHO BUYS IT
<code>.hub</code> <code>.join</code> <code>.con</code>	Community platforms and network businesses — <code>.join</code> replaces "trychroma" with <code>chroma.join</code>
<code>.anon</code>	Anonymous communities
<code>.hey</code>	Personal sites and the social long tail
<code>.cast</code> <code>.pod</code>	Podcasts and video streams — and container companies on <code>.pod</code>
<code>.tldr</code> <code>.omg</code> <code>.pop</code>	Media, remix media, publishers, music and film
<code>.learn</code> <code>.more</code>	Customer education and education-as-marketing (<code>mckinsey.learn</code>), docs
<code>.asap</code>	Delivery — Uber Eats, Instacart and their peers
<code>.mall</code> <code>.donate</code>	Shopping platforms; fundraising and non-profit landing pages
<code>.pass</code>	Memberships, season tickets, event and venue ticketing
<code>.cap</code>	Capital markets firms — <code>sequoia.cap</code>
<code>.btc</code> <code>.coin</code>	Digital currencies and memecoins
<code>.stay</code> <code>.way</code>	Hospitality, travel, the experience economy
<code>.all</code> <code>.url</code> <code>.view</code> <code>.neo</code> <code>.zap</code>	Verbal and destination plays — brand assertion (<code>share.all</code>), file sharing, duplicate basal domains (<code>news.neo</code>), faster-successor positioning
<code>.zoom</code>	Zoom as the flagship partner

Preferred partnerships: flagship names, first refusal, category exclusivity

Each of these TLDs has a company that would define it. The offer is preferred-partner status: the flagship name, right of first refusal, co-marketing, and — where it fits — the exclusive right to distribute the TLD inside their category.

7

TLDs with an obvious flagship brand

Every one a category leader

1

Available today, on a delegated TLD

`.link` — LFG already administers it

4

Instruments in the preferred-partner package

Flagship name, first refusal, co-marketing, category distribution

TLD	FLAGSHIP PARTNER	WHAT THE PACKAGE LOOKS LIKE	NOTE
<code>.link</code>	Starlink	Full package, available now — LFG administers the TLD today	The obvious first call
<code>.bnb</code>	Airbnb	Flagship name, first refusal, co-marketing	BNB is also Binance's token ticker — two large claimants
<code>.gpt</code>	OpenAI	Flagship name, category distribution	No trademark obstacle in either direction [15]
<code>.coin</code>	Binance	Flagship name, first refusal	Coinbase has at least as strong a claim on "coin"
<code>.zoom</code>	Zoom	Flagship name, category distribution	Only if LFG holds the TLD
<code>.view</code>	Figma, Adobe	Category distribution to each, in their own category	Two partners, two categories, no conflict
<code>.pod</code> <code>.cast</code>	Apple	Flagship name, category distribution	Spotify is an equally natural second partner

The four instruments

INSTRUMENT	WHAT THE PARTNER GETS
Flagship name	The premium one-word registration — <code>airbnb.bnb</code> , <code>openai.gpt</code> — reserved and allocated at launch rather than sold at auction
Right of first refusal	First option on further names in the TLD, and on renewing the arrangement before it is offered to anyone else
Co-marketing	Joint launch, named as the partner that defines the TLD, and the announcement that goes with it
Category distribution	The exclusive right to sell the TLD inside their product category, for a defined term — a real exclusive, in the channel

Category distribution is the one that is genuinely exclusive, and it is the most valuable of the four. Apple can be the only podcast platform authorised to sell `.pod` inside a podcast application. That is an ordinary commercial contract between two companies, scoped to a category and a term — the same instrument the rest of this proposal is built on, pointed at a flagship brand instead of a mid-size platform.

Why this shape rather than handing over the TLD

Three reasons, and none of them are concessions.

1. **The TLD keeps earning.** A TLD handed to one company sells once. An open `.bnb` with Airbnb as its flagship sells to every host, property manager and rental brand — while Airbnb still gets the name and the announcement it actually wanted.
2. **Multiple claimants stop being a problem.** `.view` has Figma and Adobe, `.coin` has Binance and Coinbase, `.pod` has Apple and Spotify. Handing the TLD to one forecloses the other's revenue. Category-scoped distribution does not: Figma takes design tools, Adobe takes creative suites, on the same TLD.
3. **It is a faster signature.** Distribution rights in one category is a partnerships decision, made by people who make partnerships decisions every quarter. Transferring control of a namespace is a legal and regulatory project with a different set of approvers.

There is also a rule underneath it worth knowing once: a registry cannot hand a generic TLD to a single company as a private namespace — ICANN closed that door for this round in January 2024 — and a trademarked TLD has to be applied for by its owner. Neither constraint touches any of the four instruments above, which is why the package is built from them.

`.gpt` is unusually clean on this front. OpenAI applied to register "GPT" and the USPTO **finally refused it on 6 February 2024** as merely descriptive and used industry-wide. [\[15\]](#) [\[16\]](#) There is no mark to license and no basis for an objection in either direction — LFG can operate the TLD, and OpenAI can be its flagship partner, without anyone's lawyers being involved.

TK — which of these LFG actually holds

`.zoom` only works if LFG applied for it, and `.bnb` needs a considered position on Binance before Airbnb is approached. Confirm the docket against this list before any of these names are said out loud to a partner.

How many people these platforms actually touch

Assembled from company filings, investor disclosures and tech press. Incomplete by nature — private companies disclose what flatters them — but the order of magnitude is not in doubt.

~540M

Registered accounts across the named platforms

Heavily overlapping — a ceiling, not addressable demand

~7.5M

Accounts already paying for something

Wix premium + Figma paid + Replit business + Webflow customers

10x

That paying tier vs the entire .app book

7.5M paying accounts against 750K .app domains in six years

PLATFORM	REGISTERED USERS	PAYING / BUSINESS ACCOUNTS	ENTERPRISE TIER	SCALE SIGNAL
Wix	282M registered [17]	6.2M paid premium subscriptions [17]	—	Already a registrar
GitHub	180M+ developers (225M incl. all accounts) [18]	—	—	Microsoft-owned
Replit	50M+ users [19]	500K+ business users [19]	—	~\$525M ARR, \$9B valuation [19]
Figma	~13M MAU (Mar 2025) [20]	~690K paid customers [20]	13,861 over \$10K ARR · 1,405 over \$100K · 67 over \$1M [20]	FY26 revenue guided ~\$1.37B [20]
Vercel	6M developers on v0 · 1M+ monthly Next.js devs [21]	—	OpenAI, Under Armour named [21]	~\$340M ARR, \$9.3B valuation [21]
Bolt / StackBlitz	5M registered (May 2025) [22]	—	—	\$0 to \$40M ARR in 5 months [22]
Webflow	3.5M+ users [23]	100K+ customers across 190 countries [23]	—	—
Lovable	Not disclosed	—	—	~\$400M ARR (Feb 2026) [24]
Squarespace	Not disclosed	—	—	Bought ~10M domains for \$180M [8]
Cloudflare	Not disclosed	—	—	At-cost registrar; shipped a programmatic registration API in 2026 [25]

Reading this table honestly

The 540M is a ceiling, not a market. These audiences overlap heavily — a Replit user very likely has a GitHub account — and registered accounts include everyone who ever signed up once. It is the wrong number to plan against, and I would not put it in front of a partner as though it were demand.

The ~7.5M paying tier is the real number. Wix's 6.2M premium subscriptions, Figma's ~690K paid customers, Replit's 500K business users and Webflow's 100K customers are accounts that have already produced a credit card for this category of thing, inside a billing relationship that already exists. That tier alone is **ten times the entire .app book that Google built in six years**. One integration with Wix's paid base is roughly eight times .app on its own.

That is the order-of-magnitude case, and it does not require heroic conversion assumptions. It requires the domain step to be *present* where those accounts already are.

Cloudflare just built part of this without anyone

In 2026 Cloudflare shipped an API for registering domains programmatically and has said it is heading toward registrar-as-a-service. [\[25\]](#) That is validation — the infrastructure layer independently concluded that registration belongs behind an API, inside other people's products. It is also a clock. The rails this proposal depends on are being laid by a company that could run a namespace itself.

TK — gaps I could not close from public sources

No public user count for Lovable, no domains-under-management disclosure from Cloudflare, and nothing reliable for Netlify, Framer, Render or Railway. If LFG has access to a registrar-industry data source, those four are worth filling before the target list is final.

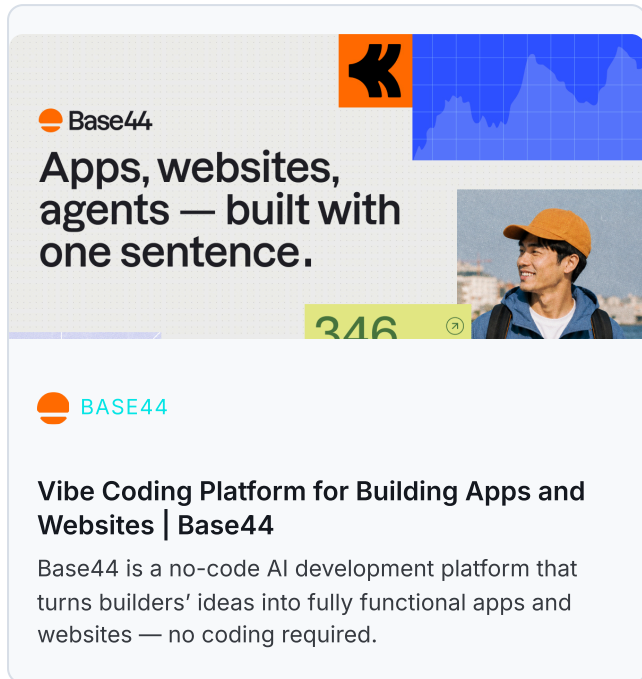
Target platforms, in the order I would work them

Tiering is by time-to-integration, not by brand. A mid-size builder that ships in six weeks is worth more to a pre-delegation channel than a household name that needs four quarters. The category is far wider than the AI-native names everyone lists.

TIER	PLATFORMS	WHY THIS TIER	THE PATH IN
1 — AI-native builders	Replit, Lovable, Bolt / StackBlitz, v0, Base44 , Mocha , Woz , Rocket , Vibe Code App	Naming is a live bottleneck in the core loop, they ship weekly, and the decision sits with a handful of people	Founder-to-founder; small teams that move on conviction
2 — Deploy & hosting	Vercel, Netlify, Railway, Render, Fly.io	Custom-domain attach is already a funnel step they measure; the integration is a known quantity	Partnerships / DX leads; the pitch is attach rate
3 — No-code app & data builders	Bubble , Glide , Knack , Ragic , SeaTable , AppSheet , UI Bakery , Fuzen , Promptly , FlutterFlow , Chef , OutSystems	The long tail nobody is pitching. Every one hosts thousands of user-built apps that each need a URL, and most hand domains off to a registrar today	Partnerships or BD; less competition for attention than tier 1
4 — Design & site builders	Figma, Webflow, Framer, Squarespace, Wix, Durable , Webstudio , Coframe , Relume , TeleportHQ , GrapesJS	Largest volume, and domains are already a real revenue line — which means an existing registrar relationship to displace or sit beside	Formal BD; longest cycle, biggest prize
Adjacent — infrastructure	Cloudflare	Category of one: already a registrar, already an infrastructure default. Partner or competitor depending on approach	Deliberate, and late — after proof from tiers 1 and 2

Tiers 1 and 3 come from [The Lossless Group's](#) own toolkit census, which tracks this category continuously — the [App Builders](#) and [Site Builders](#) tags are maintained lists, not a one-time scrape. That census is a standing asset for this engagement: the target list stays current without a research project.

The tier-1 and tier-3 cohort



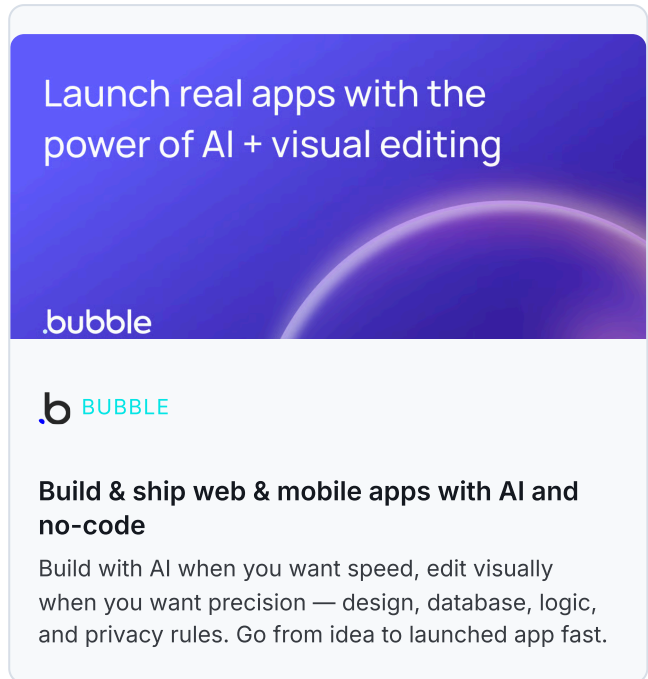
Base44

Apps, websites, agents — built with one sentence.

346

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Base44 is a no-code AI development platform that turns builders' ideas into fully functional apps and websites — no coding required.



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Build & ship web & mobile apps with AI and no-code

Build with AI when you want speed, edit visually when you want precision — design, database, logic, and privacy rules. Go from idea to launched app fast.

Why tier 3 is underrated

Everyone pitching a namespace will start at Replit and Lovable, because those are the names in the press. Tier 3 is where the volume actually sits and where nobody is competing for the partnership slot. Bubble alone hosts millions of user-built applications, and platforms like Glide, Knack, Ragic and SeaTable turn spreadsheets into deployed apps at a scale that never shows up in developer-tool coverage. Each of those apps is a thing that needs a URL, and each of those platforms currently ends that flow with a hand-off.

Why Cloudflare is not tier 1

They are the only name here that could run a namespace themselves, and they sell registrations at cost as a loyalty play. Approached cold and early, the likely outcome is a polite no plus a competitor who now knows the plan. Approached with two live integrations and demonstrated attach, the conversation is different.

TK — existing relationships

Any warm paths on your side, and anywhere you are already talking, so I do not walk into a conversation that is already running. Same for registrar relationships already in motion — the platform pitch has to be consistent with whatever the registrar channel has already promised.

What a VAR integration actually is

The single highest-leverage artefact in this engagement: a reference deal that a partnerships lead can forward internally without rewriting it.

Commercial shape

- Platform resells at its own retail price; LFG sets a wholesale floor
- Margin split on registration and renewal, with renewal weighted to reward retention
- Registry-of-record and accreditation sit behind LFG or a named registrar partner, so the platform never becomes a registrar
- Support boundary in writing: platform owns tier 1, registry owns abuse, transfers, and disputes
- Launch-phase incentives — founder pricing, reserved premium TLDs, co-marketing at delegation
- Term, exclusivity window if any, and what happens to registrations if either side walks

Technical shape

- One REST endpoint for availability, registration, and renewal — not raw EPP
- Availability check fast enough to sit inline in a naming UI
- Programmatic registration suitable for an agent acting on a user's behalf
- DNS and certificate provisioning that assumes the platform already owns the hosting
- Sandbox with fake TLDs, so a platform can build against it before delegation
- Webhooks for expiry, transfer, and abuse actions

`.link` changes what this conversation sounds like. A platform cannot schedule engineering work against a namespace that does not resolve yet, and "we will send you an API when the TLDs delegate" is how a signed partnership quietly becomes a signed partnership that shipped nothing. Because **LFG already administers a live TLD**, the first integration can be built, shipped and billed against `.link` while the 2026-round TLDs are still in evaluation. The partner gets a working product this quarter; LFG gets attach data; the new TLDs arrive later as additional inventory on an integration that already exists. A sandbox is still worth having for the un-delegated TLDs, but it is no longer what the whole plan rests on.

⚠️ TK — what exists today

Who is the intended registry backend (Identity Digital, CentralNic, Tucows, in-house), is there a registrar partner, and does any API surface exist yet even in draft? This determines whether the platform pitch is "integrate now" or "commit now, integrate later" — two very different conversations, and I would rather have the first one.

Build the API layer

Every motion in this proposal terminates in the same requirement: a platform has to be able to check availability, register, and renew programmatically. Whose API that is turns out to be a strategy decision, not a plumbing one.

Oct 2025

Vercel shipped its own Domains Registrar API

Search, price, buy, renew, transfer — the layer, already built

2

Ways to give partners an API

Ride an existing registrar, or run your own

~months

Concept to production demo, building our own

Not the multi-year platform project it sounds like

The whole proposal terminates here. A platform cannot sell a domain inside its own flow unless it can check availability, register, and renew over an API — and the zero-DNS argument from the wedge only works if that same API writes the records. Nothing in the channel plan ships without this layer existing somewhere.

It already exists at the platform end. **Vercel shipped a Domains Registrar API in October 2025** — programmatic search, pricing, bulk purchase, renewal, transfer, nameserver management. [\[26\]](#) [\[27\]](#) That is a platform building precisely the capability this proposal is asking platforms to use, which is validation, and also a warning that the integration surface is being defined right now by someone other than LFG.

The two options

	RIDE AN EXISTING REGISTRAR API	RUN OUR OWN
Time to first integration	Fast — the API exists today	Months, not years
Who owns the economics	The registrar sets margin and terms	LFG
How LFG's TLDs appear	Rows in a catalogue of every TLD on earth	The catalogue
Bundle registration	Not offered	The reason to build it
Agent-shaped naming	Availability lookup only	Suggestion, bulk, programmatic-on-behalf-of
Who owns the customer	The registrar	LFG and the platform

The incumbent path is a marketplace API such as **name.com**, which is the route a platform would take today to sell domains at all. [\[28\]](#) Selling LFG's TLDs through it works, and for a first pilot it may be exactly right — it removes accreditation, billing and compliance from the critical path.

Why the incumbent path caps the upside

In a general marketplace API, LFG's TLDs are rows. A platform that integrates a full-catalogue registrar gets `.com` in the same call, at which point the naming step reverts to a search box with a thousand results — the demand-pull shape this proposal exists to escape, re-created inside the product. The namespace's advantage is availability and coherence, and a catalogue of everything is the one context where neither is visible.

Two things promised earlier do not exist in any registrar API. The bundle — a brand across five extensions, registered in one action, renewing on one date — is the highest-value product in the portfolio section and no general registrar offers it. And agent-scale naming needs endpoints no human-facing registrar has: suggestion across a namespace, bulk availability at generation speed, registration on a user's behalf by software. Those are the two arguments that make a platform say yes, and both require an API built for this namespace rather than for all namespaces.

Why this is a months project, not a years project

I would build it, and the reason to believe that is a process claim rather than a headcount claim. **The Lossless Group has become state-of-the-art at agentic engineering — software-factory build processes, where specification, code generation, review and verification run as an instrumented pipeline rather than as a team typing.** That is the practice this very proposal was assembled with.

The realistic shape is a thin, opinionated REST layer over the registry's EPP interface: availability, suggestion, bulk check, register, renew, transfer, DNS write, webhook. Concept to production demo in a few months, with a sandbox a partner can build against long before the 2026-round TLDs delegate. This is a well-understood surface with a published protocol underneath it, not research.

The sequencing that gets both

Pilot on an existing registrar API to put a live integration in front of a partner this quarter, and build the LFG layer in parallel. The first proves the channel with no platform work wasted; the second is what the bundle and the agent products need. They are not alternatives, and doing the first does not commit you to it forever.

TK — what the backend allows

This is scoped as optional because it depends entirely on facts I do not have: the registry backend, whether LFG holds registrar accreditation or partners for it, what EPP access exists, and whether `.link` can be the testbed. Answer those and this section becomes either a concrete build plan or unnecessary.

Scope and motion

Sequenced so the expensive conversations happen after there is something to point at.

Phase 1 — Positioning and materials

The deliverable is a **channel pitch that survives being forwarded**: the thesis in "The wedge" and "The prize", rendered as a one-pager per archetype, plus the reference deal from "What a VAR integration actually is" written as terms rather than intentions. Also the target list with named owners and routes in, and an honest read of what each will object to.

This phase also resolves the TKs in this document. The pitch cannot be finished while the delegation timeline, the registry backend, and the flagship TLDs are open questions, because all three are the first things a serious partner asks.

Phase 2 — Saturate the fast tiers

Work the agentic builders and the no-code long tail **in parallel, not in sequence**. These are small teams where a partnerships decision is two conversations deep, and there are dozens of them — which makes this the tier where coverage is actually achievable inside a year rather than a multi-year enterprise slog.

The target is the category, not a sample: **every tier-1 name worth having, and a majority of the no-code and publishing platforms**, on one standard agreement. Publishing is the softest ground of all, because Substack and beehiiv already charge for custom domains — those conversations start with a company that has already decided domains are a product.

What comes out of this phase beyond the signatures: the first real attach data. How many users, offered a fresh namespace at the naming moment, take it. That number is the entire argument for the larger platforms, and nobody currently has it.

Phase 3 — The volume tiers

Take the attach data into deploy and hosting, design and site builders, the documentation engines and the GTM suites — the tiers with the largest user bases and the longest procurement. These are the accounts that turn coverage into volume, and they are winnable in year one only because phase 2 arrives carrying evidence rather than a thesis.

Cloudflare goes last, by design. By this phase the pitch is no longer an idea, which changes both who takes the meeting and what can be asked for in it.

 What I am not proposing to do

Run registrar accreditation, negotiate the registry backend contract, handle ICANN process, or build the API. That is registry work and it needs registry people. This engagement is the channel: thesis, list, terms, and signatures.

Proposed engagement

Structured so the expensive commitment comes after the unknowns are knowns, and so I am paid most when revenue arrives earliest.

1 mo

Precursor phase, scoped and priced on its own

Ends in a plan you can act on — or an honest stop

12 mo

Engagement term, gates at 2, 6 and 10 months

Each gate is a decision point, not a status review

5% → 1%

Channel participation, descending Y1 through Y5

Structured to reward frontloaded revenue

Month 1 — precursor planning

A discrete, separately priced phase whose entire job is **converting unknowns into knowns**. It exists so neither of us commits twelve months to a plan built on assumptions. Deliverables:

- **Feasibility assessment** — what the registry backend can actually support today, what `.link` can carry immediately, and what has to wait for delegation.
- **Network-to-partner map** — the target list scored by reachability, with my actual routes in named, and the gap between "reachable" and "cold" made explicit.
- **Draft VAR agreement** — the reference deal from the integration section written as terms, ready to put in front of a partner.
- **Financial projections** — the volume model rebuilt on LFG's real pricing, renewal assumptions and margin split, replacing the placeholders in this document.
- **The answers to every TK in this proposal**, closed out.

At the end of month 1 you have a plan you can execute with me, execute with someone else, or decline. That is deliberate — a precursor phase that can only conclude "hire me for a year" is not a real assessment.

Months 2–13 — the engagement

Twelve months assumed, with three gates:

GATE	WHEN	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	IF THE ANSWER IS NO
First	Month 2	Is the thesis holding in real conversations? Have the first partner meetings produced live interest rather than politeness?	Stop cheaply, having spent three months total
Second	Month 6	Is the motion repeating? Signed agreements accumulating on one standard paper, integrations shipping in parallel, something live on .link	Re-scope the motion or the target tier
Third	Month 10	Is coverage on track for a launch where the channel is live across the category, with attach data strong enough to carry the volume tiers?	Decide year two on evidence rather than optimism

Each gate is a decision point with a defined exit, not a status meeting. The month-2 gate matters most: it is the cheapest possible place to find out the channel thesis does not survive contact with real partnerships leads.

How I am paid

COMPONENT	WHAT IT IS	WHAT IT REWARDS
Retainer	Monthly fee across the twelve months	The work that happens whether or not a deal closes — thesis, materials, list, conversations
Closing bonus	A fee per partnership agreement signed	Signatures, which is the actual deliverable
Channel participation	A share of registration revenue originated through partnerships I closed, descending 5% in year one, 4%, 3%, 2%, 1% in year five	Revenue arriving early, and partnerships that produce rather than merely sign
Expenses	Conferences, travel, entertainment and business-development activity, reimbursed at cost — plus the ability to procure and use my own tools without a procurement cycle	Nothing, deliberately. It is cost, not incentive

Expenses, and where the line sits against the opening

The opening section says the cast comes out of my pocket. That is true and it stays true — **people are mine; getting in front of partners is not.**

This channel closes at conferences, on flights, and over dinners. A partnerships lead at Replit or Bubble signs after meeting someone, not after receiving a deck, and the tier-1 cohort in particular is reached at the events they already attend. Treating that as overhead I absorb would quietly convert an in-person job into an email job, and the email version of this engagement does not work. Reimbursed at cost, with whatever approval threshold you want above a sensible figure.

The tools clause matters more than it sounds. The claim in the API section — that a production demo is a months project rather than a years one — rests on a specific way of working with specific tooling, and that stack changes every few months. I need to be able to buy it and use it in the week I need it,

rather than put it through a procurement cycle that outlasts its usefulness.

Why the participation descends

A flat percentage pays the same whether a partnership produces in month three or month thirty. A descending one does not, and that is the point: **every percentage point I lose to time is a reason to get partners live and selling sooner.** It aligns me to exactly what you said this channel is for — driving year one and year two revenue, not building a pipeline that matures after the TLDs have already launched quietly.

It also means my compensation decays on its own. By year five my participation is nominal and the channel is yours outright, with no renegotiation and no argument about a legacy override.

Glossary of every name in this proposal

Reference material, not argument. Nothing here needs reading to follow the proposal; it is here so no name in it is opaque.

Companies and platforms

Agentic builders — describe what you want, it builds it

NAME	IN ONE LINE
Replit	A full development environment in the browser, with an AI agent that writes and hosts the app
Lovable	Describe an app in chat; it builds and deploys it
Bolt	Same idea, from StackBlitz, who pioneered running dev tools in a browser tab
v0	Vercel's tool for generating user interfaces from a description
Base44	Vibe-coding platform for apps and websites
Mocha , Woz , Rocket	Newer entrants doing the same thing
PartyKit	Makes any app realtime and multiplayer

No-code app builders — drag, drop, connect a database

NAME	IN ONE LINE
Bubble	The largest no-code web app builder; hosts millions of user-built apps
Glide	Turns a spreadsheet into a working business app
Knack , Ragic , SeaTable	Online databases with app builders on top
AppSheet	Google's no-code app builder
FlutterFlow	Visual builder for mobile apps
OutSystems	The enterprise incumbent in low-code
UI Bakery	Builder for internal business tools

Site builders — design a site, publish it

NAME	IN ONE LINE
Webflow	Visual website builder used by professional designers
Framer	Design tool that publishes directly as a live site
Durable	Generates a small-business website in about a minute
Relume	Generates sitemaps and wireframes from a prompt
Coframe	AI that continuously rewrites and tests page content
Webstudio , TeleportHQ , GrapesJS	Open-source visual builders

Deployment — where the thing actually runs

NAME	IN ONE LINE
Vercel , Netlify	Hosting built for front-end apps; deploy on every code change
Railway	Deploy any app or database in a click
Render , Fly.io	Managed cloud for running applications
Sealos , Coolify , Dokploy , Porter , Koyeb	One-click container deployment, self-hosted or managed

Documentation, marketing and hosting

NAME	IN ONE LINE
Starlight , Mintlify , ReadMe	Publish a product's documentation site
Kapa , Zeroheight , Docmost , Antora , Paligo	AI answers over docs, design-system docs, wikis, enterprise authoring
Conductor	Enterprise platform for winning visibility in AI search
Mutiny	Personalises a B2B website for each visiting account
Ghost	Open-source publishing and paid newsletters; used by 404 Media and Platformer
Substack , beehiiv	Newsletter platforms with paid subscriptions built in — both charge for a custom domain
Buttondown , Kit	Smaller newsletter tools aimed at independent writers and creators
Letterhead	Runs many newsletters at once for media businesses
WordPress	Still the largest publishing platform on the web
Hetzner , Hostinger	Low-cost bare-metal and shared hosting
Lambda , Modal , Nebius , Vast.ai	Rented GPU compute for AI workloads
DigitalOcean	Simple general-purpose cloud aimed at developers; the category leader
Linode	The same model, now owned by Akamai
Vultr	Developer cloud with servers in many regions
OVHcloud	Europe's largest independent cloud and hosting provider
Scaleway	French developer cloud, strong on data-residency
Contabo	German provider known for very low-cost servers

Open-source projects and command-line tools

PROJECT	IN PLAIN TERMS	HOW WIDELY USED
Agent Skills	A single markdown file that teaches an AI assistant how to do a specific task	An emerging open format; roughly a year old
Prisma	Defines your database structure in one file and generates the code to read and write it	The most widely used ORM in TypeScript
Drizzle	A lighter, newer alternative to Prisma	Fast-growing in the last two years
SQLAlchemy	The equivalent for Python	The long-standing standard in Python
libSQL	A complete database kept inside a single ordinary file	An open fork of SQLite — itself the most deployed database in the world, in every phone, browser and car
ffmpeg	Converts and processes essentially any video or audio format	Sits inside most video products you have ever used
curl	Fetches data from a web address	Ships on billions of devices
Jujutsu	A newer version-control system, compatible with Git repositories	Young, actively developed, growing fast
OpenSSL	Encryption that secures connections	Underpins a large share of the secure web
ImageMagick	Converts and edits images at scale	A standard building block in publishing pipelines
Tesseract	Reads text out of photographs and scans	The default open-source OCR engine
Pandoc	Converts documents between Word, PDF, Markdown and HTML	The standard tool for document conversion
Ollama	Runs AI language models on your own computer	The common way to run models locally
ripgrep	Searches text across thousands of files instantly	Built into many editors, including VS Code
fzf	Type a few letters and it finds the file you meant	One of the most-installed terminal tools
ExifTool	Reads and edits hidden metadata inside photos and files	The reference tool for photo metadata
eza	Lists the contents of a folder, with colour and detail	A modern replacement for a command every developer runs daily
Zellij	Splits one terminal window into many working panes	Growing replacement for tmux
Yazi , Superfile	Browse and manage files inside the terminal, very fast	Popular in the terminal-first community
Helix , Neovim	Keyboard-driven text editors	Used daily by professional developers
Atuin	Makes your command history searchable across machines	Widely adopted in the last two years
tldr	Plain-English cheat sheets for command-line tools	The common answer to "how do I use this again"
Podman	Runs software in isolated containers	The main open alternative to Docker

PROJECT	IN PLAIN TERMS	HOW WIDELY USED
GnuPG	Encrypts files and signs software releases	The standard for verifying software authenticity

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